Designing Pages and Navigation for a Multi-Page Business Application in Zoho Creator

Case Study 11

Aim

To design pages and a navigation structure for a multi-page business application in Zoho Creator.

Objective

- Understand the role of Pages in Zoho Creator.
- Create multiple pages with text, buttons, reports and images.
- Organize navigation with sections and menu items.
- Design a clean, user-friendly layout for different users.

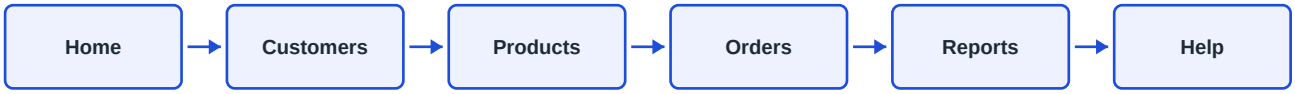
Selected Application

Sales and Inventory Management App for a small business, containing forms for Customers, Products and Orders.

Application Structure

Component	Type	Purpose
Customer	Form	Store customer details
Product	Form	Store products, price and stock
Order	Form	Create sales orders with product lookup
Home	Page	Landing page with welcome message and quick-action buttons
Product Catalogue	Page	Embedded product report with images
About / Help	Page	Instructions and contact information

Navigation Plan



Menu Section	Menu Items	Visible To
Home	Home page	All users
Sales	Customer form, Order form, Order report	Sales team, Admin
Inventory	Product form, Product catalogue page	Store manager, Admin
Reports	Dashboard, Sales report	Manager, Admin
Help	About / Help page	All users

Procedure

1. Open the application in Edit mode and click **Create Page**; name it “Home”.
2. In the Page Builder, drag elements from the left panel: **Text / Heading**, **Image**, **Buttons**, **Report** and **HTML snippet**.

3. Add buttons such as “New Order” and “Add Customer” and link them to the corresponding forms (button action: open form).
4. Create the “Product Catalogue” and “Help” pages in the same way; embed the product report into the catalogue page.
5. Open **Navigation / Sections** settings: create sections (Home, Sales, Inventory, Reports, Help) and drag forms, reports and pages into them.
6. Set the Home page as the default landing page of the application.
7. Use **Share** → **Permissions** to create roles (Admin, Sales, Manager) and decide which sections each role can see.
8. Test with Live mode and with a user account for each role.

Design Principles Applied

- **Consistency:** same colours, fonts and layout across pages.
- **Simplicity:** maximum of 5–6 menu items; frequent actions placed on the Home page.
- **Role-based view:** users see only the menu items relevant to their job.
- **Responsive layout:** pages checked on desktop and mobile views.
- **Clear labels:** descriptive names such as “New Order” instead of “Form 3”.

Observations

- Pages allow free-form layouts that standard form and report views cannot provide.
- Buttons on pages shorten the path to common tasks.
- Navigation can be customized by role, improving usability and security.

Note: Zoho Creator's interface is updated regularly, so menu names may differ slightly between versions. Add your own screenshots of each step when submitting.

Results

- Three pages (Home, Product Catalogue and Help) were created and linked to forms and reports.
- A sectioned navigation menu was organized by business function and role.
- The application behaved as a single, coherent multi-page business application.

Conclusion

Well-designed pages and navigation convert a set of forms into a professional business application. Role-based menus, quick-action buttons and clear layout make the application easy to learn and efficient to use.